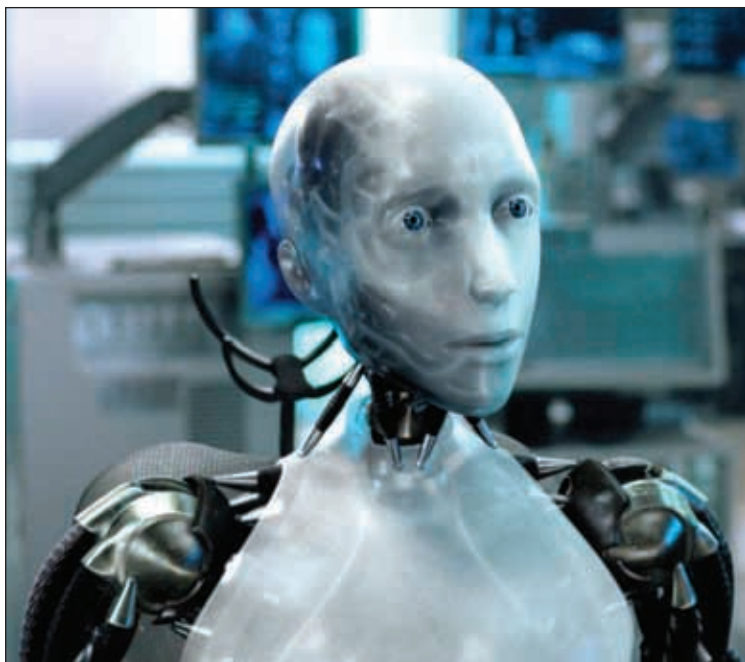




The positronic heart concept was first applied to Sonny in *I Robot*

of the hardware of artificial intelligence, with references to it being made in several different works of science fiction. Of course, various authors gave it their own spin and interpretation. *Doctor Who* used the concept several times, although being just as vague as Asimov was.

But in *Star Trek: The Next Generation*, the positronic brain made several appearances, most notably as the core circuitry of the character Data. Apparently built by Dr. Noonian Soong and based on Asimov's idea itself, the positronic brain of the android Data was meant to resemble a human brain in some ways. In the Star Trek mythology, the positronic brain is said to be so similar to the human one that when one character suffers brain damage, a positronic matrix is inserted in his brain to make him function again.

Data was also the first time that the positronic brain was actually given some specifications. According to the Memory Alpha unofficial wiki page, the positronic brain had an ultimate storage capacity of eight hundred quadrillion bits (one hundred petabytes, approximately fifty times the identifiable storage capacity of the human brain) and a total linear com-